

Demystifying Consumer Behavior

- Focuses on the core question: 'Why did they do that?'
- Moves beyond demographics to understand underlying motivations
- Traces the complete path to purchase



Marketers must act like detectives to uncover the hidden 'why' behind every purchase on the receipt.

Mapping the Consumer Journey

- The purchase is just the final destination
- The journey maps out every thought, turn, and stop
- Non-example: Buying is rarely a random, instant reflex



A GPS maps out every turn and stop long before you reach the destination.



Similarly, the buyer decision process maps every thought leading up to the final transaction.

The 5-Stage Decision Framework

- i. Need Recognition (Identifying a problem)
- ii. Information Search (Gathering data)
- iii. Evaluation of Alternatives (Comparing options)
- iv. Purchase & 5. Post-Purchase Behavior

The Framework in Action: Oishi

- Need Recognition: Feeling thirsty in the heat
- Search & Evaluation: Scanning convenience store shelves
- Purchase & Post-Purchase: Buying and feeling refreshed



Evaluating alternatives in real-time: choosing between different green tea brands based on flavor, price, and brand perception.

The 5-Stage Journey in Action

- Theoretical frameworks require practical application.
- Everyday habits follow structured psychological paths.
- Case scenario: The journey of purchasing a cold beverage.



A common, everyday product like green tea serves as the perfect case study to visualize the entire buyer decision process.

Stages 1 & 2: Need and Search

- Stage 1 (Need): Initiated by internal physiological stimuli.
- Stage 2 (Search): Active seeking of solutions in the environment.
- Shifts from feeling a physical sensation to visual scanning.



Stage 1: Internal physiological triggers, such as heat and thirst, spark immediate need recognition.



Stage 2: Information search begins immediately by scanning available physical inventory rather than deep research.

Stages 3 & 4: Evaluation and Purchase

- Stage 3 (Evaluate): Weighing specific criteria like flavor vs. price.
- Narrowing the 'evoked set' to a final choice (e.g., Tea vs. Cola).
- Stage 4 (Purchase): The physical transaction bridging intent to action.



Stage 3: The consumer evaluates alternatives in their evoked set based on specific criteria like health benefits and immediate refreshment.



Stage 4: The purchase decision is finalized through the actual transaction, committing to the evaluated choice.

Stage 5: Post-Purchase Behavior

- Assessing satisfaction immediately after consumption.
- Positive experiences prevent buyer's remorse or cognitive dissonance.
- Satisfaction reinforces future habitual purchase loops.



Stage 5: Post-purchase satisfaction ensures the consumer will repeat this specific behavioral loop in the future.

The Great Misconception

- Focusing only on the final transaction
- Treating the purchase as the entire story
- Missing the "Why" behind the action



A receipt shows what was bought, not why the customer bought it.

Transaction vs. The Full Journey

- Receipts capture only Stage 4 (Purchase)
- True behavior spans 5 full stages
- Pre-purchase journey is ignored



A receipt only represents Stage 4: The Purchase.



True consumer behavior encompasses the entire five-stage journey.

What the Transaction Misses

- Why did they enter the store? (Need)
- What information was sought? (Search)
- Which alternatives were rejected? (Evaluation)



Stage 1: The initial trigger or need recognition.



Stage 2: Searching for information and options.



Stage 3: Evaluating different alternatives.

Redefining Consumer Behavior

- Behavior is an end-to-end process
- Starts long before the store visit
- Continues after product usage
- Answers the crucial question: "Why?"

Knowledge Check: The Sneaker Scenario

- Review the 5-stage buyer decision process.
- Analyze a real-world shopping scenario.
- Trace the consumer's exact steps.
- Identify the missing stage in the sequence.



A consumer beginning their journey to replace worn-out shoes, initiating the decision process.

Mapping the Actions: Need & Search

- Stage 1: Realizing shoes are worn out.
- Trigger: Internal recognition of a problem.
- Stage 2: Asking friends for recommendations.
- Source: Relying on a personal network.



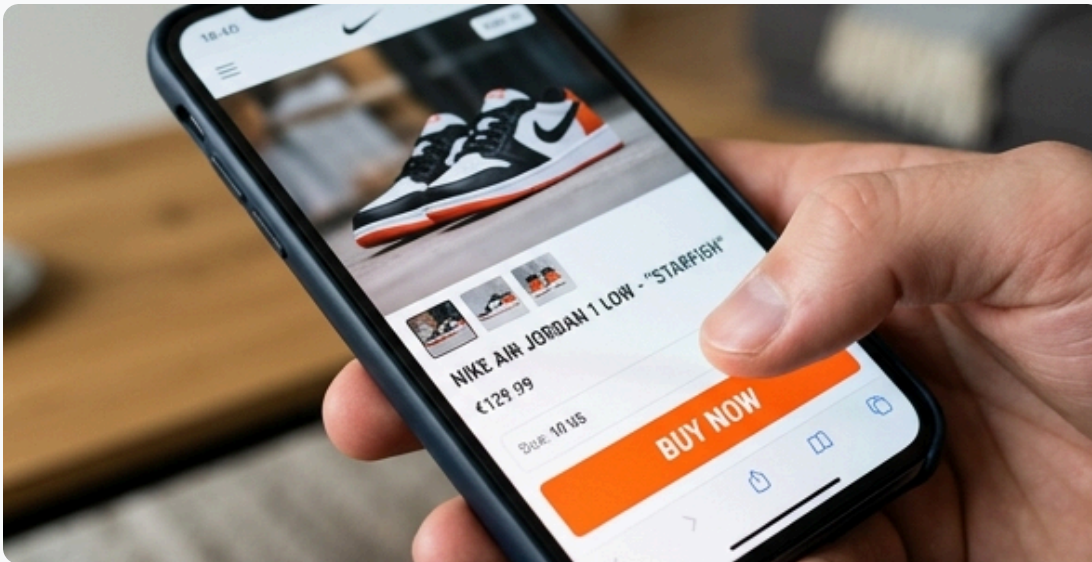
Stage 1: Need Recognition triggered by a broken, unusable product.



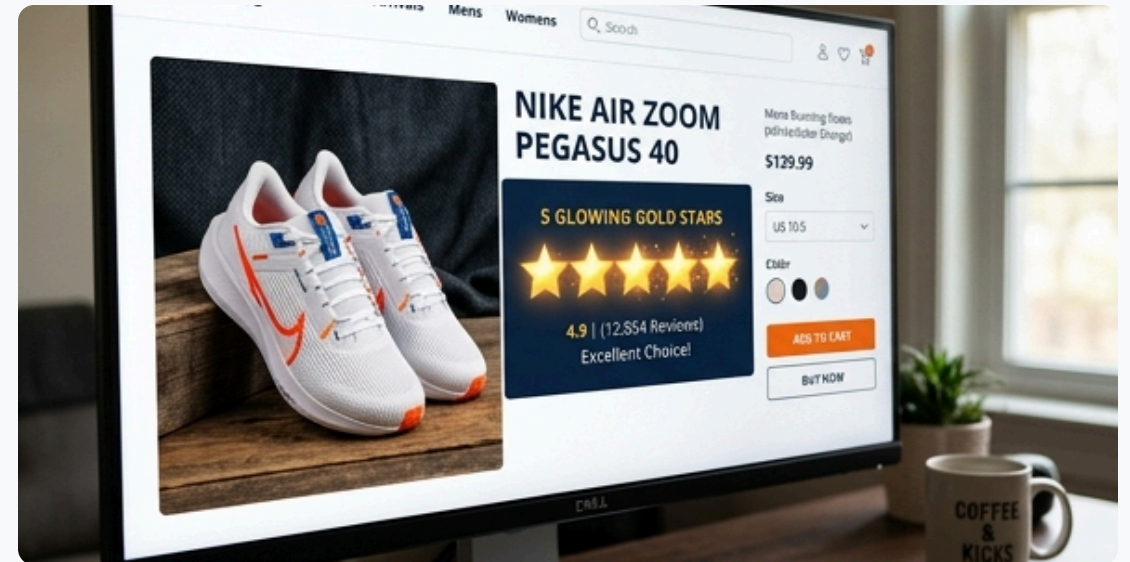
Stage 2: Information Search leveraging personal sources like friends for recommendations.

The Jump: Purchase & Review

- Action jumps to an immediate online payment.
- Stage 4: Executing the transaction.
- Customer leaves a glowing 5-star review.
- Stage 5: Displaying post-purchase satisfaction.



Stage 4: The Purchase Decision is executed immediately online.



Stage 5: Post-Purchase Behavior expressed via a highly positive review.

Spotting the Gap: The Missing Stage

- Missing link: Stage 3 (Evaluation of Alternatives).
- Skipped weighing the pros and cons.
- No comparison of price, style, or features.
- Customer did not analyze their 'evoked set'.



Stage 3: Evaluation of Alternatives involves weighing different options before committing to a purchase.